Management and Organizational Behavior

Chapter: 06. Motivation Concepts

Motivation

Making people to do the job. The desire to do the job. The process of inspiring employees to do the assigned job. Motivation is an important factor which encourages persons to give their best performance and help in reaching enterprise goals. A strong positive motivation will enable the increased output of employees but a negative motivation will reduce their performance. We define **motivation** as the processes that account for an individual's intensity, direction, and persistence of effort toward attaining a goal. While general motivation is concerned with effort toward any goal, we'll narrow the focus to organizational goals in order to reflect our singular interest in work-related behavior.

The Motivation Framework (steps):

i. Need or deficiency
ii. Search for ways to satisfy need
iii. Choice of behavior to satisfy need
iv. Evaluation of need satisfaction
v. Determination of future needs and search for satisfaction

Early Theories of Motivation

Four theories of employee motivation formulated during the 1950s, although now of questionable validity, are probably still the best known. We discuss more valid explanations later, but these four represent a foundation on which they have grown, and practicing managers still use them and their terminology.

1. Hierarchy of Needs Theory

The most well-known theory of motivation is Abraham Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs. A hierarchy of five needs-physiological, safety, social, esteem, and self-actualization in which, as each need is substantially satisfied, the next need becomes dominant.

i. Physiological: Includes hunger, thirst, shelter, and other bodily needs.

ii. Safety: Security and protection from physical and emotional harm.

iii. Social: Affection, belongingness, acceptance, and friendship.

iv. Esteem: internal factors such as self-respect, autonomy, and achievement and external factors such as status, recognition, and attention.

v. Self- Actualization: drive to become what one is capable of becoming; includes growth, achieving one's potential, and self-fulfillment.

Maslow separated the five needs into higher and lower orders. Physiological and safety needs, where the theory says people start, were **lower-order needs**, and social, esteem, and **self-actualization** were **higher-order needs**. Higher-order needs are satisfied internally (within the person), whereas lower-order needs are predominantly satisfied externally (by things such as pay, union contracts, and tenure).

Maslow's theory has received wide recognition, particularly among practicing managers. It is intuitively logical and easy to understand. When introduced, it provided a compelling alternative to behaviorist theories that posited only physiological and safety needs as important. Unfortunately, however, research does not validate it. Maslow provided no empirical substantiation, and several studies that sought to validate it found no support for it. There is little evidence that need structures are organized as Maslow proposed, that unsatisfied needs motivate,

or that a satisfied need activates movement to a new need level. But old theories, especially intuitively logical ones, apparently die hard.

2. Theory X and Theory Y

Douglas McGregor proposed two distinct views of human beings: one basically negative, labeled Theory X, and the other basically positive, labeled Theory Y.

Theory X

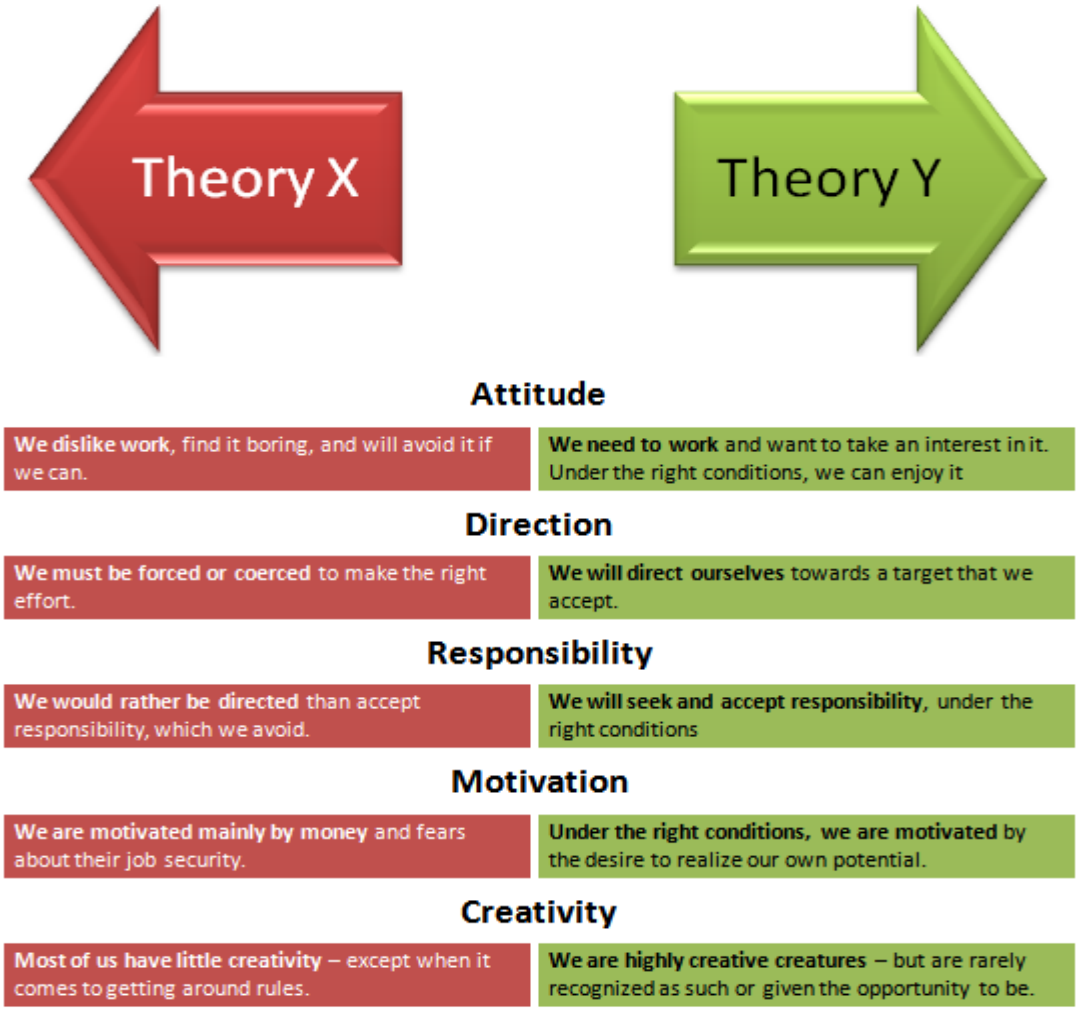
The assumption that employees dislike work, are lazy, dislike responsibility, and must be coerced to perform. Assumptions of Theory X are:

- An average employee intrinsically does not like work and tries to escape it whenever possible.
- Many employees rank job security on top, and they have little or no aspiration or ambition.
- Employees generally dislike responsibilities.
- Employees resist change.
- An average employee needs formal direction.

Theory Y

The assumption that employees like work, are creative, seek responsibility, and can exercise self-direction. An optimistic view of workers consistent with human relations approach. Assumptions of Theory Y are:

- Employees can perceive their job as relaxing and normal.
- Employees exercise their physical and mental efforts in an inherent manner in their jobs.
- They can use self-direction and self-control if they are dedicated and sincere to achieve the organizational objectives.
- An average employee can learn to admit and recognize the responsibility
- Employees are internally motivated, enjoy their job, and work to better themselves without a direct reward in return.



To understand more fully, think in terms of Maslow's hierarchy. Theory Y assumes higher-order needs dominate individuals. McGregor himself believed. Theory Y assumptions were more valid than Theory X. Therefore, he proposed such ideas as participative decision making, responsible and challenging jobs, and good group relations to maximize an employee's job motivation.

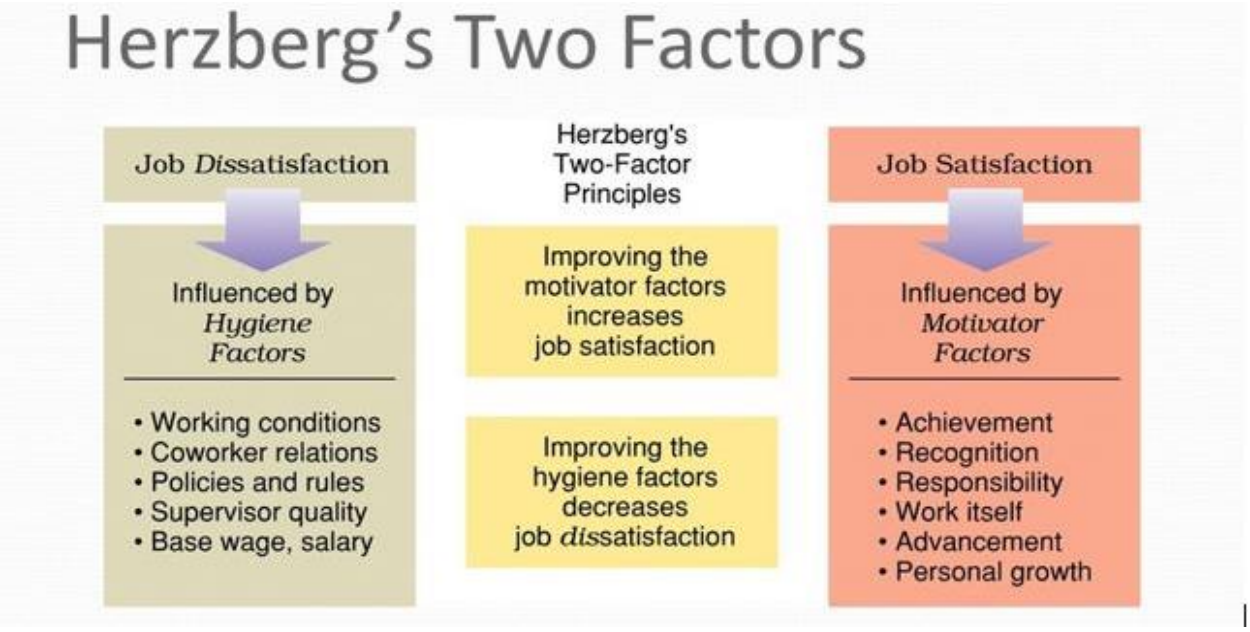
Unfortunately, no evidence confirms that either set of assumptions is valid or that acting on Theory Y assumptions will lead to more motivated workers. OB theories need empirical support before we can accept them. Theory X and Theory Y lack such support as much as the hierarchy of needs.

3. Two-Factor Theory

Frederick Herzberg developed a theory which is called Two-Factor Theory. Here one factor is Hygiene Factor and another one is Motivation Factor. The hygiene factor can cause dissatisfaction if they are not present, but do not create satisfaction when they are present. On the other hand, motivation factor can create satisfaction if they are present but do not create dissatisfaction when they are not present.

Hygiene Factors:

- Company Policy
- Supervision
- Relationship with Boss
- Work Conditions
- Salary
- Relationship with Peers



Motivation Factors:

- Achievement
- Recognition
- Responsibility
- Advancement
- Growth

The two-factor theory has not been well supported in the literature, and it has many detractors. Criticisms include the following:

1. Herzberg's methodology is limited because it relies on self-reports. When things are going well, people tend to take credit. Contrarily, they blame failure on the extrinsic environment.

2. The reliability of Herzberg's methodology is questionable. Raters have to make interpretations, so they may contaminate the findings by interpreting one response in one manner while treating a similar response differently.

3. No overall measure of satisfaction was utilized. A person may dislike part of a job yet still think the job is acceptable overall.

4. Herzberg assumed a relationship between satisfaction and productivity, but he looked only at satisfaction. To make his research relevant, we must assume a strong relationship between satisfaction and productivity.

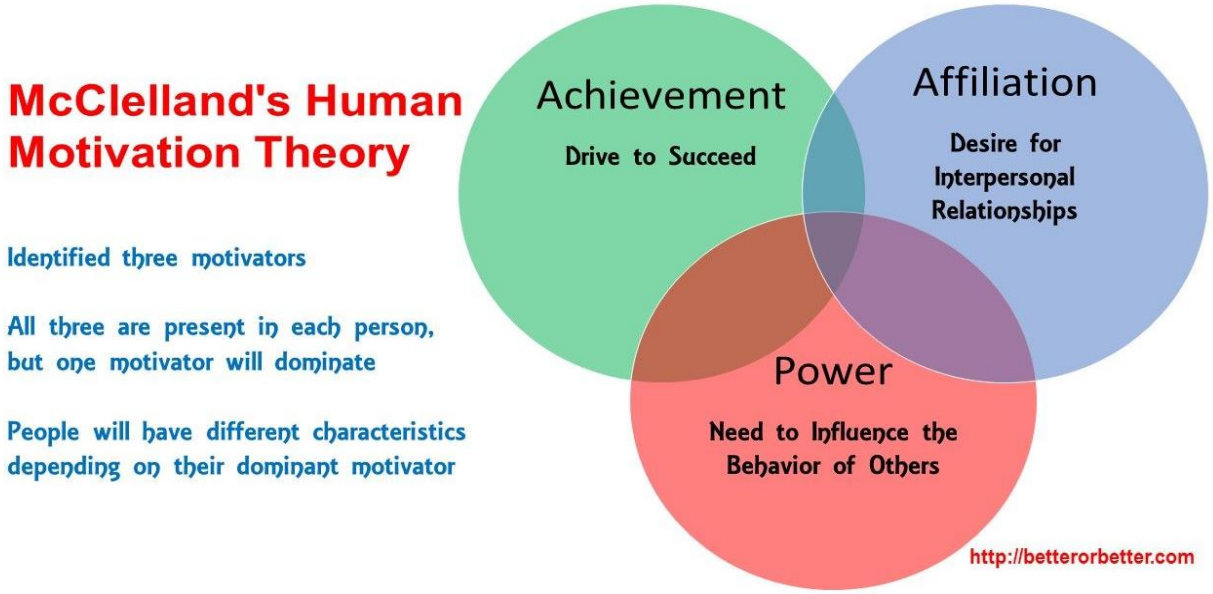
Regardless of the criticisms, Herzberg's theory has been widely read, and few managers are unfamiliar with its recommendations.

4. McClelland's Theory of Needs

McClelland's Theory of Needs was developed by David McClelland and his associates. This theory focuses on specific individual human needs that are important in organizations. The three most important needs are:

1. Need for Achievement: The desire to accomplish a goal or task more effectively than in the past. Need for achievement (nAch) is the drive to excel, to achieve in relationship to a set of standards. Assumptions are:

- Has a strong need to set and accomplish challenging goals.
- Takes calculated risks to accomplish assigned goals.
- Likes to receive regular feedback on progress and achievements.
- Often likes to work alone.



2. Need for Affiliation: The desire for human companionship and acceptance. Need for affiliation (nAff) is the desire for friendly and close interpersonal relationships. Assumptions are:

- Wants to belong to the group.
- Wants to be liked, and will often go along with whatever the rest of the group wants to do.
- Favors collaboration over competition.
- Doesn't like high risk or uncertainty.

3. Need for Power: The desire to be influential in a group and to control one's environment. Need for power (nPow) is the need to make others behave in a way they would not have otherwise. Assumptions are given below:

- Wants to control and influence others.
- Likes to win arguments.
- Enjoys competition and winning.
- Enjoys status and recognition.

Among the early theories of motivation, McClelland's has had the best research support. Unfortunately, it has less practical effect than the others. Because McClelland argued that the three needs are subconscious—we may rank high on them but not know it—measuring them is not easy. In the most common approach, a trained expert presents pictures to individuals, asks them to tell a story about each, and then scores their responses in terms of the three needs. However, the process is time consuming and expensive, and few organizations have been willing to invest in measuring McClelland's concept.